Le Gérondif (The Gerund)

The Gerund is the present participle following the preposition **en :**

En + Present Participle = The Gerund

Usage of Gerund

While

To talk about simultaneous yet related actions.

Français	English
Chloé a perdu son chapeau **en traversant** la rue.	Chloé lost her hat **while crossing** the street.
Ne parlez pas **en mangeant.**	Do not talk **while eating**.
En **allant** au marché, j'ai rencontré Antoine.	**While going** to the market, I ran into Antoine.
Il ne peut pas travailler **en parlant**.	He cannot work **while talking**.
Vous n'êtes pas autorisé à conduire **en parlant** au téléphone.	You can not drive **while talking** on the phone
Il pleurait **en racontant** l'histoire.	He was crying **while telling/narrating** the story.

J'aime écouter de la musique classique **en faisant** de la pâtisserie.	I like to listen to classical music **while making** the pastry.
En feuilletant mes livres j'ai trouvé d'anciennes photographies.	**While flipping** through my books, I found old photos.

Upon

To talk about a related action acting as a precondition/cause for the other action.

Français	English
En voyant les fleurs, elle a pleuré.	**Upon seeing** the flowers, she cried.
En rentrant, j'ai vu Ivana dormant sur le canapé.	**Upon returning** home, I saw Ivana sleeping on the couch.
En arrivant à Londres, j'irai tout de suite chez mon ami.	**Upon arriving** in London, I will go straight to my friend's house.
En apprenant le français, j'ai découvert une culture riche.	**Upon learning** French, I discovered a rich culture.
En entendant la réponse, nous avons applaudi.	**Upon hearing** the response, we applauded.

By

To explain how or why something happens

Français	English
Pablo Joshibar a gagné beaucoup d'argent **en vendant** des pommes.	Pablo J made a lot of money **by selling** apples.
C'est **en pratiquant** que vous le faites bien.	It's **by practicing** that you do it well.
Elle a maigri **en faisant** beaucoup de sport.	She got thin **by working** out a lot.
C'est **en travaillant** trop qu'on s'épuise.	It's **by working** too much that we exhaust ourselves.
En **me réveillant** à 6h, j'ai fini mon travail avant midi.	**By waking up** at 6 AM, I finished my work before noon.

Gerondif Vs Participe Present

While the present participle and gerund are identical, the gerund is almost always preceded by the preposition **en**, and that changes the whole meaning of the sentence.

Present participle: J'ai vu Thomas **sortant** du parc.

The present participle is modifying the nearest noun, **Thomas**: "I saw Thomas as he was exiting the park."

Gerund: J'ai vu Thomas **en sortant** du parc.

The gerund is modifying the **main clause subject:** "I saw Thomas as I was exiting the park."

Present Participle	Gerund
J'ai croisé mon voisin faisant du jardinage. I bumped into my neighbour **while he was gardening.**	J'ai croisé mon voisin en faisant du jardinage. I bumped into my neighbour **while I was gardening.**

Tout + Gérondif (All the While)

To **emphasise** the fact that the two actions are being done at the same time. This may also indicate a tension/contradiction between two actions.

Français	English
Tout en pleurant, il riait.	**All the while crying**, he was laughing.
Tout en enseignant le français, JM regardait le match.	**All the while teaching** French, JM was watching the match.
J'ai terminé mon master en anglais, **tout en apprenant** le français.	I finished my master's in English, **all the while learning** French
Il est possible de faire des économies **tout en vivant** dans le confort.	It is possible to save money **all the while living** comfortably.